Exit routines

Ending lessons calmly and efficiently

Use the agreed BSCS exit sequence to finish learning, restore the room and move students calmly into the corridor. Plan sufficient time for practical equipment and resource return.

How to do it well

1 Stop the academic activity. Secure attention while enough time remains to complete the room's exit routine.

2 Explain resource return. Give one clear instruction and check listening before releasing students to act.

3 Pack in stages. Cue the remaining actions, including resetting equipment and standing ready; keep students who have finished waiting calmly.

4 Check readiness. Scan the room, correct unfinished actions and move to the threshold before dismissal.

5 Dismiss deliberately. Release by the agreed row or group sequence, monitor corridor movement and leave the teaching space ready for the next lesson.

What this sounds like

"When I say go, pass the books to the end of your row and then wait. Go. Thank you. Now pack away and stand behind your chair."

Classroom example. At the end of a practical lesson, the teacher finishes the learning before giving the equipment instructions. Pupils return materials on a clear cue, reset the benches and wait ready. After checking safety and room condition, the teacher dismisses by the agreed sequence from the threshold, maintaining a view of the corridor.

Top tips that make the technique work

End the learning deliberately. Do not let premature packing swallow the final explanation or response.

Front-load each action. Tell students what to do before mentioning an object likely to trigger movement.

Use one release cue. Students should know when to act and when to wait.

Check the room before dismissal. Resource return, workspaces, uniform and equipment need a planned check.

Keep sight of the corridor. Dismiss from the threshold in a sequence that allows you to monitor both spaces.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Use the agreed sequence and concise instructions.	Allowing the bell to become the dismissal cue.
Include room-specific safety and equipment steps.	Giving several competing packing instructions at once.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

Barton - Embedding habits and routines | DistillED - Behaviour Management